



"Kashmir Crisis",
September 1, 2008

"An innocuous act of transferring land to the Shrine Board caused lots of problems in Kashmir and revoking it, a predictable reaction in the Jammu region."

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Valley of Woes

The cauldron of Pakistan-induced separatism has been simmering since Independence in the Kashmir Valley ("Kashmir Crisis: The Villains", September 1). But it is profoundly disheartening that the manipulative moves of our polity have not only put the clock back on India's attempts at wooing back the alienated people of Kashmir, but have also led to an upheaval in the relatively peaceful Jammu region, giving the issue a distinctly communal colour and driving a deeper wedge between the people of Jammu and Kashmir. NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*

The widening schism between political honour and national cohesiveness has been lucidly reflected but much of it reads like a historical mosaic. For a publication of your

stature, it was expected to be more analytical and suggestive, as you have been in the past. One hopes that you have not taken upon yourselves the task of perfecting the art of verbose critique that doesn't even initiate change. Let us at least talk about "what could or should have been" instead of just "what had been" when multiple forces are at play in a vibrant democracy. IQBAL NARAIN, *on e-mail*

It is unfair to blame only the present generation of politicians for what has happened in the Valley. They are just doing what Jawaharlal Nehru, the first prime minister of India, Hari Singh, the last ruling maharaja of the princely state of Jammu and Kashmir and Sheikh Abdullah, one of the most important political figures in the modern history of the state had done 61

years ago. Their indecisiveness, inaction and personal ambition is the root cause of the present imbroglio in the Valley. While analysing the present, the past should not be ignored.

VIJAY DANDIWALA, *on e-mail*

The phenomenon of Pakistani flags flying flagrantly throughout the Valley and separatists being applauded for their seditious speeches is nothing new. It is clear now: the land for the shrine is only an excuse, not an issue. When our very own leaders are playing second fiddle to the separatists and top bureaucracy lying prostrate in their servitude, do we need a Pakistan to export terrorism to India? KARAN KHARB, *on e-mail*

Unfortunately, most of our politicians consider nationalism as communalism. If appeasement and

regionalism are not replaced by nationalism, we should be ready to face a civil war-like situation some time soon.

HEMESH K. VARSHNEY, *Noida*

Army was withdrawn from various pockets of Kashmir after Mehbooba cried foul over its deployment, but there was no respite for the common people in Jammu. Life has become very stifling in the current circumstances, thanks to the imbroglio over the Amarnath land row. SANDEEP JAIN, *Jammu*

Best Collection

Most of the 61 institutions have not only stood the test of time but have kept up with the changing trends ("What Makes India Work," August 25). Perpetually growing with an eye on the future and a ear to the past, these institutions have played a pivotal role in catapulting India's